# Important Questions with Answers

Chapter 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation
Class 9 Social Science (NCERT) - Understanding Society: India and Beyond, Part 1

*A. MCQs  B. Fill in the Blanks  C. True/False  D. Match the Following  E. Assertion-Reason  F. Short Answer  G. Long Answer*

## A. Multiple Choice Questions (1 mark each)

**Q1. The period before the invention of writing is understood mainly through:**

(a) Written documents
(b) Archaeological evidence
(c) Coins
(d) Travelogues

**Answer:** (b) Archaeological evidence

**Q2. The undeciphered script of the Harappan civilisation is also called:**

(a) Brahmi
(b) Cuneiform
(c) Sindhu lipi
(d) Hieroglyphic

**Answer:** (c) Sindhu lipi

**Q3. Which script was formalised by Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE?**

(a) Cuneiform
(b) Brahmi
(c) Hieroglyphic
(d) Sindhu lipi

**Answer:** (b) Brahmi

**Q4. More than what percentage of human history falls in the period before writing?**

(a) 50 per cent
(b) 75 per cent
(c) 99 per cent
(d) 10 per cent

**Answer:** (c) 99 per cent

**Q5. Our early ancestors who evolved into Homo sapiens are known as:**

(a) Australopithecines
(b) Hittites
(c) Neanderthals only
(d) Sumerians

**Answer:** (a) Australopithecines

**Q6. Which early human ancestor was the first hominin to exit Africa, around 2 million years ago?**

(a) Homo habilis
(b) Homo erectus
(c) Homo neanderthalensis
(d) Homo sapiens

**Answer:** (b) Homo erectus

**Q7. Homo habilis lived in:**

(a) Olduvai Gorge, Tanzania and Kenya
(b) Europe
(c) China
(d) Australia

**Answer:** (a) Olduvai Gorge, Tanzania and Kenya

**Q8. Handaxes and cleavers were made by:**

(a) Homo habilis
(b) Homo erectus
(c) Homo sapiens only
(d) Neolithic farmers

**Answer:** (b) Homo erectus

**Q9. The preserved remains, traces or impressions of plants, animals or humans from the distant past are called:**

(a) Artefacts
(b) Fossils
(c) Ores
(d) Inscriptions

**Answer:** (b) Fossils

**Q10. Tiny stone tools used in the Mesolithic period are called:**

(a) Handaxes
(b) Cleavers
(c) Microliths
(d) Choppers

**Answer:** (c) Microliths

**Q11. The World Heritage Site of Bhimbetka in Madhya Pradesh is famous for:**

(a) Harappan seals
(b) Painted rock shelters
(c) Pyramids
(d) Dockyards

**Answer:** (b) Painted rock shelters

**Q12. The hallmark of the Neolithic revolution was:**

(a) Use of iron
(b) Domestication of plants and animals
(c) Invention of the bow and arrow
(d) Cave painting

**Answer:** (b) Domestication of plants and animals

**Q13. The oldest Neolithic site of the Indian subcontinent (about 7000 BCE) is:**

(a) Lothal
(b) Mehrgarh
(c) Kalibangan
(d) Dholavira

**Answer:** (b) Mehrgarh (on the Bolan River)

**Q14. Mixing copper and tin to make bronze marks the:**

(a) Neolithic period
(b) Bronze Age
(c) Mesolithic period
(d) Iron Age

**Answer:** (b) Bronze Age

**Q15. The word 'Mesopotamia' means:**

(a) Land of rivers
(b) Land in between
(c) Black land
(d) Fertile land

**Answer:** (b) Land in between (Greek name for the land between the Euphrates and Tigris)

**Q16. The tower-like stepped temple of the Sumerians was called a:**

(a) Mastaba
(b) Ziggurat
(c) Pyramid
(d) Stupa

**Answer:** (b) Ziggurat

**Q17. The Code of Hammurabi was compiled in:**

(a) Egypt
(b) Babylonia
(c) China
(d) Sumer

**Answer:** (b) Babylonia

**Q18. Meluhha, mentioned in Mesopotamian records, is generally identified with:**

(a) Egypt
(b) China
(c) The Sindhu-Sarasvati civilisation
(d) Bahrain

**Answer:** (c) The Sindhu-Sarasvati civilisation

**Q19. The Rosetta Stone helped in deciphering the script of:**

(a) Mesopotamia
(b) Egypt
(c) China
(d) Harappa

**Answer:** (b) Egypt (deciphered by Champollion in 1822)

**Q20. The Chinese civilisation grew along the:**

(a) Nile and Tigris
(b) Huang He and Yangtze
(c) Indus and Ganga
(d) Euphrates and Nile

**Answer:** (b) Huang He (Yellow River) and Yangtze

## B. Fill in the Blanks (1 mark each)

**Q21. The Harappan civilisation is also known as the Indus Valley Civilisation or the _____ Sarasvati civilisation.**

**Answer:** Sindhu

**Q22. The cuneiform script was used by the _____ in Mesopotamia.**

**Answer:** Sumerians

**Q23. The scripts of Sumer and Egypt mark the beginning of the _____ period, about 5000 years ago.**

**Answer:** historical

**Q24. Modern humans are called _____ sapiens.**

**Answer:** Homo

**Q25. The Quaternary Period covers the last _____ lakh years.**

**Answer:** 26

**Q26. The earliest stone tools were made about _____ million years ago.**

**Answer:** 3.3

**Q27. The Neanderthals (Homo neanderthalensis) made Middle Palaeolithic _____ tools.**

**Answer:** flake

**Q28. In India, _____ in Tamil Nadu is dated to about 1.5-1.7 million years ago.**

**Answer:** Attirampakkam

**Q29. The first villages were established during the _____ period.**

**Answer:** Neolithic

**Q30. People who used copper along with stone tools are called _____ people.**

**Answer:** Chalcolithic

**Q31. Harappan ploughed fields at _____ show evidence of double cropping (Rabi and Kharif).**

**Answer:** Kalibangan

**Q32. The four early river valley civilisations include the Harappan, Mesopotamian, Egyptian and _____ civilisations.**

**Answer:** Chinese

**Q33. Egyptians referred to their land as _____, meaning 'the black'.**

**Answer:** Kemet

**Q34. Egyptian rulers were called _____.**

**Answer:** Pharaohs

**Q35. The Great Wall of China was initially built from 680 BCE onwards as protection against raids by _____ tribes.**

**Answer:** nomadic

## C. True or False (1 mark each)

**Q36. The Harappan script has been deciphered.**

**Answer:** False. It has not yet been deciphered.

**Q37. Before writing, tools and other artefacts are the major sources for reconstructing people's lives.**

**Answer:** True.

**Q38. After writing was invented, dating of events becomes relatively more accurate.**

**Answer:** True. Written documents mention specific dates such as coronations and wars.

**Q39. Our earliest ancestors evolved and lived in Africa.**

**Answer:** True.

**Q40. Homo sapiens evolved in Asia around 300,000 years ago.**

**Answer:** False. Homo sapiens evolved in Africa around 300,000 years ago.

**Q41. Discarded tools and fossils help archaeologists reconstruct human history.**

**Answer:** True.

**Q42. The Mesolithic period is a transitional phase between hunting-gathering and agriculture.**

**Answer:** True.

**Q43. Fishing was the mainstay of the Mesolithic subsistence economy.**

**Answer:** True. (As given in the chapter for Mesolithic hunter-gatherers.)

**Q44. The transition to agriculture happened at the same time everywhere in the world.**

**Answer:** False. It took place at different periods in different areas.

**Q45. Mehrgarh people were the first in the subcontinent to make copper objects.**

**Answer:** True.

**Q46. The Harappans did not have a standard system of weights.**

**Answer:** False. They had standard weights, using binary multiples for smaller units and multiples of ten for larger ones.

**Q47. Mesopotamia and the Indus valley were in contact through trade.**

**Answer:** True.

**Q48. Sumerian temples were centres of economic activity.**

**Answer:** True.

**Q49. Egyptian pyramids were built because of the belief that a person's ka lived on after death if the body was preserved.**

**Answer:** True.

**Q50. China was the first country to introduce paper currency.**

**Answer:** True.

## D. Match the Following (1 mark per pair)

**Q51. Match the period with its main feature.**

| | Column A | | Column B |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Palaeolithic | A | Copper used along with stone tools |
| 2 | Mesolithic | B | Shift from hunting-gathering to settled life, domestication |
| 3 | Neolithic | C | Widespread use of iron, stronger tools and weapons |
| 4 | Chalcolithic | D | Hunting-gathering with simple stone tools |
| 5 | Iron Age | E | Microlithic tools, transitional phase |

**Answer:** 1-D; 2-E; 3-B; 4-A; 5-C

**Q52. Match the early human with a feature.**

| | Column A | | Column B |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Homo habilis | A | Made handaxes and cleavers; first to migrate out of Africa |
| 2 | Homo erectus | B | Early ancestors whose name means 'southern primates' |
| 3 | Homo neanderthalensis | C | Lived in Europe and Southwest Asia till about 40,000 years ago |
| 4 | Homo sapiens | D | Only human species living today |
| 5 | Australopithecines | E | Made chopper stone tools; the 'handy man' |

**Answer:** 1-E; 2-A; 3-C; 4-D; 5-B

**Q53. Match the civilisation with its feature.**

| | Column A | | Column B |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Mesopotamia | A | Rosetta Stone, pyramids, papyrus |
| 2 | Egypt | B | Shang, Zhou, Qin and Han dynasties |
| 3 | China | C | Dholavira water harvesting and Lothal dockyard |
| 4 | Harappan | D | Code of Hammurabi |
| 5 | Babylonia | E | Cuneiform script and ziggurats |

**Answer:** 1-E; 2-A; 3-B; 4-C; 5-D

## E. Assertion-Reason Questions (1 mark each)

***Options:*** *(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. (b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A. (c) A is true but R is false. (d) A is false but R is true.*

**Q54. Assertion (A): Early human history is studied mainly through archaeology.**
**Reason (R): Written records did not exist before about 5000 years ago.**

**Answer:** (a)

**Q55. Assertion (A): Early humans are called 'hominins' or tool makers.**
**Reason (R): They made tools, which animals do not have the cognitive ability to make.**

**Answer:** (a)

**Q56. Assertion (A): The Neolithic change is called a revolution.**
**Reason (R): Humans started producing food through domestication of plants and animals and established the first villages.**

**Answer:** (a)

**Q57. Assertion (A): Dating of events is only approximate before the invention of writing.**
**Reason (R): Written documents mention specific dates of events.**

**Answer:** (a) After writing, dating becomes relatively accurate; before it, dating is approximate.

**Q58. Assertion (A): The Harappan script is understood by scholars today.**
**Reason (R): Cuneiform and hieroglyphic scripts have been deciphered.**

**Answer:** (d) A is false; R is true. The Harappan script is still undeciphered.

**Q59. Assertion (A): Early civilisations emerged in river plains.**
**Reason (R): Rivers provided water, fertile soil and navigable routes for farming and trade.**

**Answer:** (a)

**Q60. Assertion (A): Mesopotamia traded with the Harappans.**
**Reason (R): The Indus and Ghaggar-Sarasvati valleys are geographically close to Mesopotamia.**

**Answer:** (a)

**Q61. Assertion (A): Egyptian pyramids were built primarily as palaces for the Pharaohs.**
**Reason (R): Egyptians believed in a ka that lived on after death if the body was preserved.**

**Answer:** (d) A is false; R is true. Pyramids were built as tombs for Pharaohs after death.

## F. Short Answer Questions (2 to 3 marks each)

**Q62. How do we know about the period before writing?**

**Answer:** Mainly through archaeological evidence: tools, bones, fossils, cave art and other objects left behind. Archaeologists explore sites and also experiment with making and using similar tools to understand early life.

**Q63. Name three early writing systems.**

**Answer:** The Harappan script (undeciphered), the cuneiform of the Sumerians in Mesopotamia and the hieroglyphic script of ancient Egypt.

**Q64. Differentiate between biological and cultural evolution.**

**Answer:** Biological evolution is the gradual physical and genetic change by which australopithecines evolved into Homo sapiens. Cultural evolution is how humans adapted to their surroundings during the Quaternary Period by developing tools, techniques and technology.

**Q65. What is a hominin?**

**Answer:** A group that includes modern humans and our early human-like ancestors. They are known as tool makers.

**Q66. Why are tools called 'extra-corporal limbs'?**

**Answer:** Because they functioned as extensions of the human body, helping people do tasks that they could not do with their hands alone.

**Q67. What are fossils? How do they help?**

**Answer:** Fossils are preserved remains, traces or impressions of plants, animals or humans that got buried in layers of earth and slowly turned to stone. Along with tools, they are major evidence for reconstructing human history.

**Q68. Describe Homo habilis.**

**Answer:** Homo habilis ('handy man') lived 2-6 million years ago in Olduvai Gorge, Tanzania and Kenya, and made chopper stone tools.

**Q69. Who were the Neanderthals?**

**Answer:** Homo neanderthalensis lived in Europe and Southwest Asia till about 40,000 years ago and made Middle Palaeolithic flake tools.

**Q70. Name the six periods of early human history.**

**Answer:** Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic, Chalcolithic, Bronze Age and Iron Age.

**Q71. What tools did Palaeolithic people in India use and for what?**

**Answer:** Handaxes, cleavers, scrapers and choppers made of quartzite and limestone, used to chop meat, dig tubers, scrape skins and break bones for marrow. Later tools included borers and points tipped on projectiles.

**Q72. What advances were made by Upper Palaeolithic humans?**

**Answer:** They invented the bow and arrow, blades, microblades and burins; hunted small game; made cave paintings, used pigments for their bodies; and produced the first beads of stone, bone and shell.

**Q73. Why did the population increase in the Mesolithic period?**

**Answer:** The climate became warmer around 12000 years ago, forests and grasslands expanded, and new resources such as small game, fish and wild grains became available, leading to the first population explosion.

**Q74. What is the Neolithic revolution?**

**Answer:** The gradual transition from hunting-gathering to a food-producing life through domestication of animals and plants. People made pottery, used polished stone tools and established the first villages.

**Q75. What was special about Mehrgarh?**

**Answer:** It is the oldest Neolithic site and earliest agricultural village in the subcontinent (about 7000 BCE) with mud-brick houses and granaries, wheat and barley, sheep, goats and zebu, ornaments, and was the first to make copper objects.

**Q76. What was the Early Harappan phase?**

**Answer:** A stage showing cultural continuity in pottery, beads, bangles, terracotta and copper working. Perimeter walls, seals and script probably began here and led to the growth of Harappan urban centres.

**Q77. What do the Harappan weights show?**

**Answer:** They had standard systems of weights using binary multiples (1, 2, 4, 8, 16) for small units and multiples of ten for large ones. This helped long-distance trade.

**Q78. How did Harappans manage water?**

**Answer:** They built check dams called gabarbands across streams. At Dholavira, water from two streams was diverted by dams and canals into deep stone and mud-brick tanks. Lothal has a huge dockyard of burnt bricks.

**Q79. Why were rivers important to early civilisations?**

**Answer:** Rivers gave water, fertile soil for farming and routes for trade and transport. Four early civilisations (Harappan, Mesopotamian, Egyptian and Chinese) emerged in river plains.

**Q80. What is a city-state?**

**Answer:** A sovereign state centred around a city that rules the surrounding territories. Examples: Ur and other Sumerian cities.

**Q81. What was a ziggurat?**

**Answer:** A tower-like stepped pyramid-shaped temple with several floors above which the main temple was located. The city grew around it; the area around held palaces and royal storehouses, and it served as the city's treasury.

**Q82. What is cuneiform?**

**Answer:** One of the earliest writing systems, developed by the Sumerians around 3200 BCE. It was written by pressing a wedge-shaped stylus into soft clay tablets.

**Q83. Name any three contributions of the Sumerians.**

**Answer:** Canal and dam irrigation, use of mud and burnt bricks, wheeled cart and sailboat, cuneiform writing, and a number system based on 60 (the 60-minute hour, 60-second minute and 360-degree circle).

**Q84. What is the Code of Hammurabi?**

**Answer:** A compilation of rules and regulations for civil and social conduct made by the Babylonian king Hammurabi (1792 BCE). It was a foundational model for many future legal systems.

**Q85. How was the Egyptian script deciphered?**

**Answer:** Pierre Bouchard, a French engineer, found the Rosetta Stone in 1799. It had three types of writing including Greek. In 1822 Jean-Francois Champollion deciphered the script.

**Q86. What is papyrus?**

**Answer:** A paper-like material made by cutting the inner trunk of the papyrus plant into strips, criss-crossing, pressing, drying and polishing them into sheets. Egyptian records and stories were written on it.

**Q87. Why did Egyptians build pyramids?**

**Answer:** They believed every person had a ka (spiritual double) that lived on after death if the body was preserved through mummification. Pharaohs were buried deep underground with mastabas placed over the burial chamber; stacked mastabas formed pyramids such as the step pyramid at Saqqara.

**Q88. What is known about Egyptian women?**

**Answer:** They enjoyed more rights than Greek or Roman women: they could own property and run businesses. Cleopatra (69-30 BCE) was trained from childhood to rule and became queen at 18.

**Q89. How do we know about early China?**

**Answer:** From abundant historical records and especially 'oracle bones' - symbols on animal bones and tortoise shells that were heated until they cracked; the cracks were interpreted to foretell the future.

**Q90. What was the Great Wall of China built for?**

**Answer:** Several walls were built from 680 BCE onwards by the Zhou and other dynasties to protect against violent raids of nomadic tribes. They were later joined into an effective defence and repaired till the 17th century CE.

**Q91. Why was the Silk Route called so?**

**Answer:** Around the 2nd century BCE, during the Han dynasty, silk became a major item of external trade, so the whole trade route came to be known as the Silk Route.

## G. Long Answer Questions (5 marks each)

**Q92. Explain how the invention of writing changed the study of history (before and after writing).**

**Answer: Human history:** more than 99% falls before writing (about 3 million years ago to 5000 years ago); less than 1% falls after it.
**Main sources:** before writing, tools and artefacts; after writing, both material remains and written documents.
**Lives of people:** before writing it is difficult to understand thoughts and ideas; literature gives names, events and social, political and cultural life.
**Measurement of time:** before writing dating is approximate; after writing it becomes relatively accurate as documents mention coronations, wars and other dates.
Early writing systems include the Harappan (undeciphered), cuneiform and hieroglyphic scripts.

**Q93. Describe the origin and spread of early humans.**

**Answer:** Our earliest ancestors, the australopithecines, evolved in Africa and over time became Homo sapiens. Around 3.3 million years ago one of them made the earliest stone tools. Homo habilis (handy man) lived in Olduvai Gorge in Tanzania and Kenya and made chopper tools. Homo erectus made handaxes and cleavers and was the first hominin to leave Africa about 2 million years ago, spreading into Asia and Europe between 2 and 0.5 million years ago. Neanderthals lived in Europe and Southwest Asia till about 40,000 years ago. Homo sapiens evolved in Africa around 300,000 years ago, moved out around 125,000 years ago and spread all over the world including Australia and the Americas (50000-12000 years ago). Homo sapiens developed complex technologies and are the only human species alive today.

**Q94. Describe the life of Palaeolithic and Mesolithic hunter-gatherers.**

**Answer: Palaeolithic ('Old Stone Age'):** people hunted and gathered and lived in caves and open camps. In India the oldest settlement is about 2 million years old (Attirampakkam, Isampur). Tools: handaxes, cleavers, scrapers, choppers (quartzite, limestone), later borers and points. Later, Homo sapiens invented the bow and arrow, blades, microblades and burins, decorated cave walls, used pigments, and made beads.

**Mesolithic:** around 12000 years ago climate became warmer. Forests and grasslands expanded; small game, fish and wild grains became available, causing a population explosion. Microlithic tools helped gather aquatic food; fishing was the mainstay. Art flourished, with paintings in caves and rock shelters such as Bhimbetka (Madhya Pradesh).

**Q95. Explain the Neolithic revolution and the Neolithic period in the Indian subcontinent.**

**Answer:** The Neolithic revolution was the gradual change to food production through domestication of plants and animals, development of new breeds through cultivation and husbandry, pottery, tools for food production and processing, and the first village settlements - laying the foundation for urban life. It did not occur at the same time everywhere.

**India:** Mehrgarh on the Bolan River (about 7000 BCE) is the oldest Neolithic site, with mud-brick houses and granaries, burials, ornaments of lapis lazuli, carnelian and shells; wheat, barley, sheep, goats and zebu; and copper objects, making them Chalcolithic by about 4000 BCE. This laid the basis for the Bronze Age Sindhu-Sarasvati civilisation (about 3500 BCE). By 2500 BCE most of the subcontinent had Neolithic communities (e.g. Sanganakallu).

**Q96. Describe the Early Harappan stage and the achievements of the Harappans.**

**Answer:** Introduction of copper tools in the alluvial plains of the Indus and Ghaggar-Sarasvati basins increased productivity. Regional pottery styles, beads, shell bangles, terracotta and copper working developed. Perimeter walls, seals and the script probably began in this stage, leading to urban centres by about 2600 BCE.

**Achievements:** ploughed fields at Kalibangan with double cropping; crafts such as bead making (Harappa, Kunal, Datrana); standard weights and measures; check dams (gabarbands); the water harvesting system of Dholavira; the Lothal dockyard; and long-distance trade with Mesopotamia (Meluhha), Dilmun and Magan, trading beads, ivory, timber, gold dust and copper.

**Q97. Describe the Mesopotamian civilisation.**

**Answer:** Mesopotamia ('land in between') lies between the Euphrates and Tigris in West Asia; the 'fertile crescent' has high agricultural potential. Copper arrived about 4500 BCE. It had four major city-based civilisations:

1. **Sumerians** (Ur and other cities): dams and canals, mud and burnt bricks, ziggurats, temple-centred economy, cuneiform (around 3200 BCE), wheeled cart, sailboat, number system based on 60.
2. **Akkadians** (from 2334 BCE, city of Akkad): first dynastic empire; Sargon traded with Dilmun, Magan and Meluhha.
3. **Assyrians** (from 2154 BCE, Assur).
4. **Babylonians** (from 1900 BCE): Hammurabi (1792 BCE) and the Code of Hammurabi; weakened by 1400 BCE by Hittite attacks and internal problems.

Cuneiform tablets record myths, hymns, law codes and the Epic of Gilgamesh.

**Q98. Describe the Egyptian civilisation.**

**Answer:** It grew along the Nile. Every summer the river flooded, leaving rich mud ('kemet'), so Egypt was called Kemet (the black). Farmers dug ditches and reservoirs and developed a calendar by counting the days between floods (365 days; three seasons of four months). Collective efforts led to local government and city-states around 3000 BCE, and Pharaohs became rulers. Pyramids (e.g. step pyramid at Saqqara) were built as tombs because of belief in the ka and mummification. Society was a pyramid: Pharaoh, officials/nobles/priests, free landholders/artisans/merchants, serfs and slaves. Egyptians wrote on papyrus; the script was deciphered with the Rosetta Stone. They enjoyed festivals, music, and games; women had considerable rights (e.g. Cleopatra).

**Q99. Describe the Chinese civilisation.**

**Answer:** It flourished along the Huang He (Yellow River) and Yangtze, where Neolithic cultures date to about 7000 BCE. Copper/bronze metallurgy arrived about 2000 BCE, and urban centres emerged about 1600 BCE. Dynasties: Shang (1600-1046 BCE), Zhou (1046-256 BCE), Qin (221-206 BCE, source of the name 'China') and Han (206 BCE-220 CE). Iron became popular by 600 BCE.
**Sources:** historical records and oracle bones.
**Features:** logographic script; jade and bronze craft; the Great Wall (from 680 BCE to the 17th century CE); silk and the Silk Route (Han dynasty); a stratified society; money economy by the 5th century BCE; first paper currency; and civil services by public examination.

**Q100. 'Bronze Age civilisations developed independently but shared common features.' Explain.**

**Answer:** Harappan, Mesopotamian, Egyptian and Chinese civilisations emerged independently in fertile river plains (Sindhu-Sarasvati, Euphrates-Tigris, Nile, Huang He).
**Common features:**
- Agricultural productivity and use of copper/bronze increased growth.
- Urban cities and craft production.
- Trade, and in some cases contact (Mesopotamia and Harappa).
- Social hierarchy and administrative systems (city-states, Pharaohs, dynasties).
- Writing systems for recording transactions and later literature.
- Monumental architecture (ziggurats, pyramids, Great Wall, planned Harappan cities).

Egypt and China had little tangible evidence of direct contact with the Harappans, showing independent development.

**Q101. Compare the Neolithic way of life with the Palaeolithic and Mesolithic ways of life.**

**Answer: Palaeolithic:** hunting-gathering; simple stone tools (handaxes, cleavers); caves and open camps; later bows and arrows, cave art, beads.
**Mesolithic:** warmer climate; microlithic tools; fishing and use of small game and wild grains; temporary settlements near rivers and lakes; rich rock art (Bhimbetka); population explosion.
**Neolithic:** domestication of plants and animals; polished stone tools; pottery; permanent villages (Mehrgarh); surplus food and the foundation for civilisation.
Thus the lifestyle moved from mobile food-collecting to settled food-producing.